

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

PHASE 2: REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

Project Detail	Information
Domain	Information Technology
Project Type	Individual Project
Platform	ServiceNow
Primary Area	IT Service Management (ITSM)
Project Scenario	Corporate VPN incident lifecycle from creation to resolution

Prepared as part of the seven-phase project documentation

1. Phase Overview

Requirement analysis converts the project idea into clear expectations for the ServiceNow solution. This phase answers three important questions: what the system must do, who will use it, and what evidence will prove that the project is working. For this project, the requirements are centered on a Corporate VPN incident that moves through the complete incident lifecycle.

2. Business Objective

The primary objective is to implement and demonstrate a structured Incident Management process in ServiceNow from incident creation through resolution and closure-related validation. The process should make it possible to classify the incident, use knowledge during troubleshooting, move the record to the correct support team, perform Level 2 investigation, connect the incident to Change Management when a technical change is needed, link related incidents, document the solution, create reusable knowledge, and review SLA information.

3. Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Detailed expectation
FR-01	Service and service offering	The system should represent Remote Access as the service and Corporate VPN as the service offering used by the incident scenario.
FR-02	Incident creation	A support user should be able to create an incident for a Corporate VPN connectivity or authentication problem.
FR-03	Incident classification	The incident should capture relevant classification values such as Network category, VPN subcategory, urgency, service, service offering, and configuration item where applicable.
FR-04	Knowledge assistance	The support user should be able to search or use Agent Assist to identify relevant knowledge during troubleshooting.
FR-05	Assignment and escalation	The incident should be able to move from the Service Desk to the Network or Level 2 team when the issue requires deeper technical investigation.
FR-06	Investigation updates	Technical users should be able to record work notes, investigation findings, and progress information on the incident.
FR-07	Change linkage	When the resolution requires an urgent infrastructure or configuration change, an emergency change should be created and related to the incident.
FR-08	Child incident	A child incident should be created or linked when another user is affected by the same underlying issue.
FR-09	Resolution documentation	The incident should contain

		probable cause, resolution notes, and the final resolution information before it is moved to a resolved state.
FR-10	Knowledge creation	A reusable knowledge article should be created from the verified solution so that future incidents can benefit from the same troubleshooting information.
FR-11	SLA and related-record validation	The completed incident should allow review of SLA information and related records such as child incidents and linked changes.
FR-12	End-to-end validation	The full scenario should be tested from creation through final validation to show that the lifecycle works as intended.

4. Requirements Mentioned by the Project Brief

The project brief also refers to workflow automation, notifications, SLAs, and approval workflows. These are important platform-level requirements and should be included in the documentation as intended capabilities. However, the final project demonstration should claim only the items that are actually configured in the ServiceNow instance. If notifications or approval workflows were not explicitly built during implementation, they should be listed as planned or future enhancements rather than presented as completed features.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement
Usability	The workflow should be understandable to a Service Desk analyst and should use standard ServiceNow forms and related lists wherever possible.
Traceability	Important actions should be recorded through incident fields, work notes, state changes, and linked records.
Consistency	The same classification and escalation logic should be followed during repeated demonstrations of the scenario.
Maintainability	The configuration should use recognizable ServiceNow records and naming so that an administrator can understand what was created.
Security	Users should access only the functions allowed by their ServiceNow roles. The academic demonstration should avoid exposing real credentials or sensitive production data.
Reliability	The test scenario should be repeatable without depending on hidden manual steps that cannot be explained to the evaluator.
Performance	The demonstration should load and update records at normal training-instance speed without unnecessary custom logic.

6. Stakeholder Requirements

Stakeholder	Requirement
End user	Needs the incident to represent the real issue accurately and to receive a clear resolution.
Service Desk	Needs enough information to classify the incident, use knowledge, and decide whether escalation is required.
Network / Level 2 team	Needs technical context, current notes, service details, CI information, and the ability to document investigation results.
Change Management participant	Needs a change record that explains why the change is necessary and how it relates to the incident.
Project evaluator / mentor	Needs visible evidence that the full lifecycle has been implemented and tested rather than only described.

7. Data and Record Requirements

The project uses several ServiceNow record types. The incident is the central record, but the value of the solution comes from the relationships around it. The following data elements should therefore be available during the implementation and demonstration.

Record / data element	Purpose in the project
Business Service: Remote Access	Represents the higher-level service affected by the incident.
Service Offering: Corporate VPN	Identifies the specific offering used by the affected employee.
Configuration Item (CI)	Provides technical context for the device or infrastructure involved in the scenario, when used.
Incident	Tracks the user issue, classification, assignments, notes, state, and resolution.
Knowledge Article	Provides existing troubleshooting guidance and stores the final reusable solution.
Change Request	Represents the emergency change required to restore service when applicable.
Child Incident	Represents another affected user or related incident linked to the parent issue.
Task SLA / SLA information	Shows the service-level timing associated with the incident.

8. Assumptions and Constraints

- The project is implemented in a ServiceNow training, developer, or academic environment rather than a live production environment.
- The user has sufficient roles and permissions to create and update the records required for the demonstration.
- Sample users, groups, and configuration items may be used when organization-specific production data is not available.
- The project demonstrates the process and record relationships; it does not attempt to reproduce the scale or governance of a full enterprise rollout.
- Any feature described as configured must be demonstrable in the instance. Items that exist only in the project brief should be clearly identified as requirements or future work.

9. Acceptance Criteria

Acceptance criterion	Evidence of completion
Service hierarchy is available	Remote Access and Corporate VPN can be selected or shown in the incident context.
Incident can be created and classified	The incident contains the VPN issue and the planned classification values.
Knowledge can support troubleshooting	Relevant knowledge is searched, viewed, or associated through the available knowledge/Agent Assist experience.
Escalation works	Assignment changes from Service Desk to Network / Level 2 and the record remains traceable.
Technical investigation is documented	Work notes or investigation details are visible.
Change relationship is visible	An emergency change is created and linked when the scenario requires it.
Related incident relationship is visible	A child incident exists and is linked to the parent incident.
Resolution is complete	Probable cause and resolution notes are present and the incident is in the resolved state.
Knowledge is captured	A knowledge article is created from the final solution.
Final validation is possible	Related records and SLA information can be reviewed at the end of the scenario.

10. Requirements Traceability

A simple traceability view helps connect the requirements to later project phases. This prevents the documentation from becoming a collection of unrelated screenshots and makes it easier for an evaluator to see why each implementation step exists.

Requirement area	Designed in	Implemented / demonstrated in
Service hierarchy	Design phase - service model	Development - service and service offering setup
Incident lifecycle	Design phase - process flow	Development - creation, classification, reassignment, resolution
Knowledge	Design phase - module interaction	Development - Agent Assist/knowledge search and article creation
Change linkage	Design phase - related-record model	Development - emergency change and incident relationship
Child incident	Design phase - parent/child relationship	Development - child incident creation and validation
SLA validation	Planning/testing design	Development and final validation

11. Phase Conclusion

The requirement analysis phase defines exactly what the project is expected to demonstrate. It also separates project requirements from implementation claims, which is important during evaluation. The result is a set of functional requirements, non-functional requirements, stakeholder needs, record requirements, assumptions, and acceptance criteria that can be used to guide the design and testing of the ServiceNow solution.